

CV

JOÃO DE DEUS VIDAL JR.

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Researcher portfolio: <http://bit.ly/4fLdrPW>

Google Researcher ID: [PLmmm4QAAAAAJ&hl](https://scholar.google.com/citations?hl=pt-BR&user=PLmmm4QAAAAAJ&hl)

Metrics: 894 citations; 12 h-index; 35 publications.

ORCID: <https://orcid.org/0000-0002-0420-4102>



1. ACADEMIC QUALIFICATIONS

Universidade Estadual Paulista “Júlio de Mesquita Filho” 2014–2018

Doctor's degree - Biological Sciences (Botany)

- Research Interests: Patterns of endemism and diversification of plants in highlands in the Brazilian Cerrado.

Universidade Federal de São Carlos 2012–2014

Master's degree - Biological Diversity and Conservation

- Research Interests: Biogeography of pantropical genus *Rauvolfia* (Apocynaceae).

Universidade Federal de São Carlos 2008–2011

Bachelor's degree - Biological Sciences

2. WORK EXPERIENCE

Universitat Leipzig, Leipzig 2024–now

Postdoctoral Fellow

Plants & Politics AG, LeipzigLab

Str. des 17. Juni 2, Leipzig, Germany, phone: +49 0341 9730340

Universitat Passau, Passau 2024–2024

Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter

Department of Geography, Universität Passau

Innstraße 40. Passau, Bayern, Germany, phone: +49 (15) 0004-13931-E24.

Universitat Passau, Passau 2022–2024

Postdoctoral Fellow (Alexander von Humboldt International Climate Protection Fellowship)

Department of Geography, Universität Passau

Innstraße 40. Passau, Bayern, Germany, phone: +49 (15) 0004-13931-E24.

Royal Botanic Gardens Kew, London 2023–2023

Visiting Researcher (Alexander von Humboldt International Climate Protection Fellowship)

Spatial Analysis and Data Science. The Jodrell Laboratory, Royal Botanic Gardens, Kew
Surrey TW9 3DS, UK.

Universidade Estadual de Campinas, Campinas 2020–2021

Postdoctoral Fellow

Laboratório de Análise Genética e Molecular, Universidade Estadual de Campinas, Av. Cândido Rondon, 400. Campinas, São Paulo, Brazil, phone: +55 (19) 3521-1134.

University of the Free State, Phuthaditjhaba 2019–2020

Postdoctoral Fellow

Afromontane Research Unit QwaQwa Campus Private Bag X13, Phuthaditjhaba, 9866, Republic of South Africa, phone: +27 (58) 718 5407.

Universidade Estadual de Campinas, Campinas 2018–2019

Postdoctoral Fellow

Laboratório de Análise Genética e Molecular, Universidade Estadual de Campinas, Av. Cândido Rondon, 400. Campinas, São Paulo, Brazil, phone: +55 (19) 3521-1134.

3. PUBLICATION RECORD

- Lelouvier, R., Schneiderbauer, S., Collins, S., Moikwathai, B., **Vidal Jr., J. de D.**, Jacobs, L., & Clark, V. R. (2026). Towards a multilateral 'Southern African Mountain Treaty/Convention' – a contribution to the Southern African Development Community Vision 2050. Transactions of the Royal Society of South Africa. <https://doi.org/10.1080/0035919X.2026.2661548>
- Abdulkadir, M., Bello, A., Abdulkadir, S. H., Tajuddeen, A., Wada, N., Haruna, M., Kankara, S. S., **Vidal Jr., J. D.**, & Muellner-Riehl, A. (2026). Medicinal flora of the Umaru Musa Yar'adua University Herbarium: A taxonomic survey. Feddes Repertorium, 137(2), e70114. <https://doi.org/10.1002/fedr.70114>
- Clark, V. Ralph, **Vidal Jr., J. D.**, Gwynne-Evans, D., Barker, N. P. (2026). Two new endemic species of *Hermannia* L. (Malvaceae: Byttnerioideae)—*H. lilacina* and *H. boschbergensis*—from the Cape Midlands Escarpment (Eastern Cape, South Africa). *South African Journal Of Botany*, 189, 125–132.
- Münder, N., Fremout, T., Bello, A., Oluoch, W. A., Schmitt, C. B., Muellner-Riehl, A. N., & **Vidal Jr., J. D.** (2026). Hotspots of timber species declines in Nigeria: evidence from species distribution models under climate and land use change. *Regional Environmental Change*, 26(1). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10113-026-02529-7>
- Clark, V. R., **Vidal Jr., J. D.**, & Barker, N. P. (2026). *Acmadenia kamdeboo* (Rutaceae: Diosmeae)—A new species endemic to the Kamdebooberge, Sneeuwberg Massif (Eastern Cape, South Africa). *South African Journal of Botany*, 188, 374–380.
- Pepin, N., Apple, M., Knowles, J., Terzago, S., Arnone, E., Hänchen, L., Napoli, A., Potter, E., Steiner, J., Williamson, S.N., Ahrens, B., Dhar, T., Dimri, A.P., Palazzi, E., Rameshan, A., Salzmann, N., Shahgedanova, M., **Vidal Jr., J. D.**, Zardi, D. (2025) Elevation Dependent Climate Change in Mountain Environments. *Nature Reviews Earth & Environment*, 6, 772–788.
- Mapaura, A., Canavan, K., Richardson, D. M., **Vidal Jr., J. D.**, & Clark, V. R. (2025). Implications of climate change for the distribution of the invasive grass genus *Nassella* in South Africa and Lesotho. *Rangeland Ecology & Management*, 103, 367–376.
- Baracat, A. F., Pereira Nunes, C. E., Milet-Pinheiro, P., & **Vidal Jr., J. D.**, (2025). Combining distribution models of plants and their mutualists to map gaps in the knowledge of ecological interactions. *Diversity and Distributions*, 31(10), e70090.
- Vidal Jr., J. D.**, Antonelli, A., Carbutt, C., Clark, V. R., Fremout, T., Chapano, C., *et al.*, (2025). Late 21st-century climate and land use driven loss of plant diversity in African mountains. *Global Change Biology*, 31(9), e70492.
- Sieben, E., Steenhuisen, S., **Vidal Jr., J. D.**, Martin, G., & le Roux, P. (2024). Modelling landscape-scale occurrences of common grassland species in a topographically complex mountainous environment. *Plant Ecology*, 225(10), 1095–1108.
- Schmitt, C. B., & **Vidal Jr., J. D.**, (2024). Global Patterns of Biodiversity in Forests. In *Routledge Handbook of Forest Ecology* (2nd ed.). Routledge.
- de Moura, Y. A., Aono, A. H., Cruz, M. V., Pereira, A. A., **Vidal Jr., J. D.**, & de Souza, A. P. (2024). Molecular attributes of the tropical tree *Avicennia schaueriana* involved in the response and tolerance to low temperatures. *bioRxiv*, 2024–02.
- Vidal Jr., J. D.**, Schmitt, C., & Koch, I. (2023). Comparative richness patterns of range sizes and life-forms of Apocynaceae along forest-savanna transitions in Brazil. *Bot. J. of Linnean Soc.* 204 (3), 230–241.
- Oluoch, W., Borgemeister, C., **Vidal Jr., J. D.**, Fremout, T., Gaisberger, H., Whitney, C., & Schmitt, C. (2023). Predicted changes in distribution and richness of wild edible plants under climate change scenarios in northwestern Kenya. *Regional Environmental Change* 24 (1), 11.
- Vidal Jr., J. D.**, Mori, G., Cruz, M., da Silva, M., de Moura, Y., & de Souza, A. (2022). Differential Adaptive Potential and Vulnerability to Climate-Driven Habitat Loss in Brazilian Mangroves. *Front. Conserv. Sci*, 3, 763325.

- The Brazil Flora Group** (2022). Leveraging the power of a collaborative scientific network. *Taxon* 71(1), 178–198.
- Da Silva, M. F., Cruz, M. V., **Vidal Jr, J. D.**, Zucchi, M. I., Mori, G. M., & De Souza, A. P. (2021). Geographical and environmental contributions to genomic divergence in mangrove forests. *Biological Journal of the Linnean Society*, 132(3), 573–589.
- Vidal Jr, J. D.**, le Roux, P. C., Johnson, S. D., te Beest, M., & Clark, V. R. (2021). Beyond the Tree-Line: The C 3-C 4 “Grass-Line” Can Track Global Change in the World’s Grassy Mountain Systems. *Frontiers in Ecology and Evolution*, 9.
- Delves, J. L., Clark, V. R., Schneiderbauer, S., Barker, N. P., Szarzynski, J., Tondini, S., **Vidal Jr, J. D.**, & Membretti, A. (2021). Scrutinising Multidimensional Challenges in the Maloti-Drakensberg (Lesotho/South Africa). *Sustainability*, 13(15), 8511.
- Timberlake, J., V. R. C., Petra Ballings, **Vidal Jr, J. D.**, Wursten, B., Hyde, M., Mapaura, A., Childes, S., Palgrave, M. C. (2020). Mountains of the Mist: A first plant checklist for the Bvumba Mountains, Manica Highlands (Zimbabwe-Mozambique). *Phytokeys*, 145, 93–129.
- Clark, V. R., Sokhela, L., & **Vidal Jr, J. D.** (2019). The afromontane research unit: reaching for new heights. *Mountain Research and Development*, 39(4), P1.
- Clark, V. R., **Vidal Jr, J. D.**, Grundy, I. M., Fakarayi, T., Childes, S. L., Barker, N. P., & Linder, H. P. (2019). Bridging the divide between intuitive social-ecological value and sustainability in the Manica Highlands of southern Africa (Zimbabwe-Mozambique). *Ecosystem Services*, 39, 100999.
- Clark, V. R., & **Vidal Jr, J. D.** (2019). The vegetation of Asante Sana Private Game Reserve and surrounds, Sneeuwberg Centre of Floristic Endemism. In *Esperiana Memoir 8: The Lepidoptera fauna of a crater valley in the Great Escarpment of South Africa: The Asante Sana Project*. (Vol. 8, pp. 25–39). Bad Staffelstein.
- Clark, V. R., **Vidal Jr, J. D.**, & Barker, N. (2019). A new, localised species of purple radiate Senecio (Asteraceae: Senecioneae) from the Sneeuwberg massif, South Africa. *Phytotaxa*, 406(3), 180–190.
- Cortez, M. B. D. S., Sforca, D. A., Alves, F. D. M., **Vidal Jr, J. D.**, Alves-Pereira, A., Mori, G. M., Andreotti, I. A., Do Nascimento Jr, J. E., Bittrich, V., Zucchi, M. I., & others. (2019). Elucidating the *Clusia criuva* species ‘complex’: Cryptic taxa can exhibit great genetic and geographical variation. *Botanical Journal of the Linnean Society*, 190(1), 67–82.
- Vidal Jr, J. D.**, & Clark, V. R. (2019). Afro-Alpine Plant Diversity in the Tropical Mountains of Africa. In *Encyclopedia of the World’s Biomes* (p. 22). Elsevier.
- Vidal Jr, J. D.**, de Souza, A. P., & Koch, I. (2019). Impacts of landscape composition, marginality of distribution, soil fertility and climatic stability on the patterns of woody plant endemism in the Cerrado. *Global Ecology and Biogeography*, 28(7), 904–916.
- The Brazil Flora Group** (2018). Brazilian Flora 2020: Innovation and collaboration to meet Target 1 of the Global Strategy for Plant Conservation (GSPC). *Rodriguésia*, 69, 1513–1527.
- Gomes, S. S. L., **Vidal Jr, J. D.**, Neves, C. S., Zorzatto, C., Campacci, T. V. S., Lima, A. K., Koehler, S., & Viccini, L. F. (2018). Genome size and climate segregation suggest distinct colonization histories of an orchid species from Neotropical high-elevation rocky complexes. *Biological Journal of the Linnean Society*, 124(3), 456–465.
- Vidal Jr, J. D.** (2018)* PhD thesis. *Histórico da ocupação das chapadas brasileiras por espécies do gênero Rauvolfia L. (Apocynaceae) e suas implicações biogeográficas*.
- Vidal Jr, J. D.**, Cortez, M. B., Alves, F. M., Koehler, S., de Souza, A. P., & Koch, I. (2018). Development and cross-validation of microsatellite markers for *Rauvolfia weddeliana* Müll. Arg. (Apocynaceae) species complex. *Brazilian Journal of Botany*, 41(3), 681–686.
- Messias, P. A., **Vidal Jr, J. D.**, Koch, I., & Christianini, A. V. (2014). Host specificity and experimental assessment of the early establishment of the mistletoe *Phoradendron crassifolium* (Pohl ex DC.) Eichler (Santalaceae) in a fragment of Atlantic Forest in southeast Brazil. *Acta Botanica Brasilica*, 28, 577–582.

Vidal Jr, J. D., (2014) Masters thesis. *Biogeografia do gênero Rauvolfia L.(Apocynaceae, Rauvolfioideae).*

Editorial Work

Guest Editor, Special Volume *Frontiers in Ecology and Biogeography—Impacts and Adaptations in Montane Ecosystems Facing Climate Change* (2025).

4. TEACHING AND SUPERVISION EXPERIENCE

2024. Lecturer/Content developer BESTNATURE Modules (online course). [Beginner] [Governance and management of Protected Areas] [Overview of international policies and agreements for conserving biodiversity] Universität Passau. Passau, Germany.
2024. Bachelor Thesis supervision (International Cultural and Business Studies). Haslberger, S. *Ecosystem services: Case Study on the Impact of Shrimp Farming on Aquaculture on Mangrove Ecosystem Services*. Universität Passau. Passau, Germany.
- 2022/2023. Lecturer: 101953 | HS Regionale Geographie Allgemeine/Regionale Geographie / Physische Geographie: Challenges and targets for the conservation of biodiversity in Latin America (43825) Allgemeine/Regionale Geographie / Physische Geographie (Advanced seminar). (24 teaching hours) Universität Passau. Passau, Germany.
2022. Lecturer: 101943 | HS Regionale Geographie Allgemeine/Regionale Geographie / Physische Geographie: Challenges and targets for the conservation of biodiversity in Latin America (43830) Allgemeine/Regionale Geographie / Physische Geographie: Challenges and targets for the conservation of biodiversity in Latin America (Advanced seminar). (24 teaching hours). Universität Passau. Passau, Germany.
2021. Postgraduate Lecturer: Aplicações do melhoramento molecular: Conservação e ecologia. BV 782. (2 teaching hours) Universidade Estadual de Campinas (UNICAMP), Brazil.
2019. Invited Lecturer: BOTA3734—7 Biogeography. (2 teaching hours) University of the Free State, Qwaqwa Campus. Phuthaditjhaba. South Africa.
2018. Postgraduate Lecture: Acrylamide genotyping for microsatellite markers. (4 teaching hours) Universidade de Campinas. Campinas. Brazil.
2015. Invited Lecturer: Ciências Biológicas (BSc)—Methods of field sampling of plants. (2 teaching hours) Universidade Federal de São Carlos. Sorocaba. Brazil.

5. ORAL PRESENTATIONS IN CONFERENCES

- The International Biogeography Society (TIBS) Aarhus - 12th Biennial Conference. Aarhus. *What species are being used by different restoration practices and what does that mean for the Sahel? A north Nigerian case-study (Speaker)*. 2026. (Conference).
- European Conference of Tropical Ecology (GTOE 2024). Lisbon. *Exploring multi-level species responses to environmental changes in tropical mountainous ecosystems (Session host, speaker)*. 2024. (Conference).
- International Mountain Conference (IMC2022). Innsbruck. *Beyond the Tree-Line: The C3-C4 "Grass-Line" Can Track Global Change in the World's Grassy Mountain Systems*. 2022. (Conference).
- European Conference of Tropical Ecology (GTOE 2022). Montpellier. *Differential Adaptive Potential and Vulnerability to Climate-Driven Habitat Loss in Brazilian Mangroves*. 2022. (Conference).
- European Conference of Tropical Ecology (GTOE 2022). Montpellier. *Afromontane regions: past and future of mountain biodiversity under a changing climate*. 2022. (Conference).
- Brazilian Congress of Botany 2021. 71o Congresso Nacional de Botânica e o XIII Encontro de Botânicos do Centro-Oeste. *O endemismo das chapadas do Cerrado brasileiro*. 2021. (Congress).

Botany2020 (online congress). Botanical Society of America. *Landscape composition, marginality, and climatic stability roles on the patterns of woody plant endemism in the Cerrado*. 2020. (Congress).

The Conservation Symposium. Howick, KwaZulu-Natal. *Invited Keynote Speaker: Southern African Mountain Ecosystems - Indicators for Changes in Biodiversity*. 2019. (Symposium).

54° Grassland Society of Southern Africa Annual Congress. *Southern African Mountain Ecosystems - Indicators for Changes in Biodiversity*. 2019. (Congress).

IMC2019. Southern African Mountain Ecosystems - Indicators for Changes in Biodiversity. 2019. (Congress).

Mini school of evolution. *Biogeography of Angiosperm: lonely wanderers drifting?* 2015. UFSCar, Sorocaba - SP, Brazil. (Extension project).

6. PARTICIPATION IN CONGRESSES, MEETINGS, AND OTHERS

European Conference of Tropical Ecology (GTOE 2026). Germany. (Conference).

The International Biogeography Society 12th Biennial conference (TIBS Aarhus 2026). Denmark. (Conference).

iDiv Conference 2024. Germany. (Conference)

European Conference of Tropical Ecology (GTOE 2024). Portugal. (Conference).

European Conference of Tropical Ecology (GTOE 2023). Czech Republic. (Conference)

Gender and climate change. 2022. Universität Passau, Germany. (Panel moderation).

International Mountain Conference (IMC2022). Austria. (Conference)

European Conference of Tropical Ecology (GTOE 2022). France. (Conference)

12th International Conference for Prospective Leaders in Climate Protection and climate-related Resource Conservation. Alexander von Humboldt Stiftung, Germany. (Online Conference).

Brazilian Congress of Botany: 71o Congresso Nacional de Botânica e o XIII Encontro de Botânicos do Centro-Oeste. 2021, Brazil. (Online Congress)

Botany2020. Botanical Society of America. 2020, United States. (Online Congress).

2020 Congress of the South African Association of Botany—SAAB 2020. 2020. (Congress)

The Conservation Symposium (SANBI—South Africa). 2019. (Symposium)

54° Meeting of the Grasslands Society of Southern Africa. 2019. (Meeting)

2019 International Mountain Conference. 2019, Austria. (Conference)

67° Congresso Nacional de Botânica. 2017, Brazil. (Congress).

XIII Congresso de Ecologia/III International Symposium of Ecology and Evolution. 2017. (Congress).

66° Congresso Nacional de Botânica. 2015, Brazil. (Congress).

II Workshop de Biogeografia. 2014, Brazil. (Workshop).

Simpósio de Biologia Vegetal. 2014, Brazil. (Symposium).

XI Congresso Latino-Americano de Botânica. 2014, Brazil. (Congress).

64° Congresso Nacional de Botânica. 2013, Brazil. (Congress).

International Symposium on Phylogeography. 2010, Brazil. (Symposium).

Scientific Committees

European Conference of Tropical Ecology GTOE 2026, Passau, Germany.

Grassland Society of Southern Africa (GSSA) Conferences (2019–2021). Upington, South Africa.

7. RELEVANT COURSEWORK

2022. MRI Workshop: From Elevation Dependent Warming to Elevation Dependent Climate Change. 2022. Austria. (Workshop)

2022. GEO Mountains workshop: Identifying Essential Socioeconomic Variables (ESVs) across Global Mountains. 2022. Austria. (Workshop)

2021. Assessing Species' Extinction Risk Using IUCN Red List Methodology. (online course, 12h). International Union For Conservation Of Nature And Natural Resources-Sui, IUCNNR.

2019. Biodiversity Data Management, including Darwin Core data standards, data cl. (course offered at the University of Free State, South Africa, 14h). Global Biodiversity Information Facility.

2018. Specialized Module On Cities And Climate Change. (online course, 2h). United Nations Institute for Training and Research, UNITAR.

2018. UN CC: Learn Introductory E-Course On Climate Change. (online course, 12h). United Nations Institute for Training and Research, UNITAR.

2010. Visual languages in communication. (60h). UFSCar - campus Sorocaba, UFSCAR, Brazil.

2010. Knowledge, wisdom, and science (online course, 5h). Fundação Getulio Vargas, Brazil.

2010. Philosophy. (30h). Fundação Getulio Vargas - SP, FGV-SP, Brazil.

2009. Environmental education – Transversal knowledge. (14h). SENAI, Brazil.

8. MEMBERSHIPS IN SCIENTIFIC COMMUNITIES

The International Biogeography Society (member).

Geographische Gesellschaft Passau GeoComPass (member). **Germany.**

Alexander von Humboldt Stiftung (alumni association). **Germany.**

Afromontane Research Unit (associated researcher). **South Africa.**

Society for Tropical Ecology GTÖ (member). **Germany.**

Grassland Society of South Africa (scientific board evaluator). **South Africa.**

Global Mountain Biodiversity Assessment (early career network member). **Switzerland.**

9. ACHIEVEMENTS

International Climate Protection Fellowship 2022-2023 Call. **Alexander von Humboldt Foundation, Germany.**

Top performance ARU postdoctoral researcher 2019. **University of the Free State, South Africa.**

Highest publication number ARU postdoctoral researcher 2019. **University of the Free State, South Africa.**

Highest impact factor publication ARU postdoctoral researcher 2019. **University of the Free State, South Africa.**

10. LANGUAGES

German A2 (2022). IFS (Institut für Sprachvermittlung und internationalen Kulturaustausch), Bonn, Germany.

German A1 (2021-2022). IFS (Institut für Sprachvermittlung und internationalen Kulturaustausch), Bonn, Germany.

English proficiency (ETS TOEFL-ITP, 653, C1) (2014).